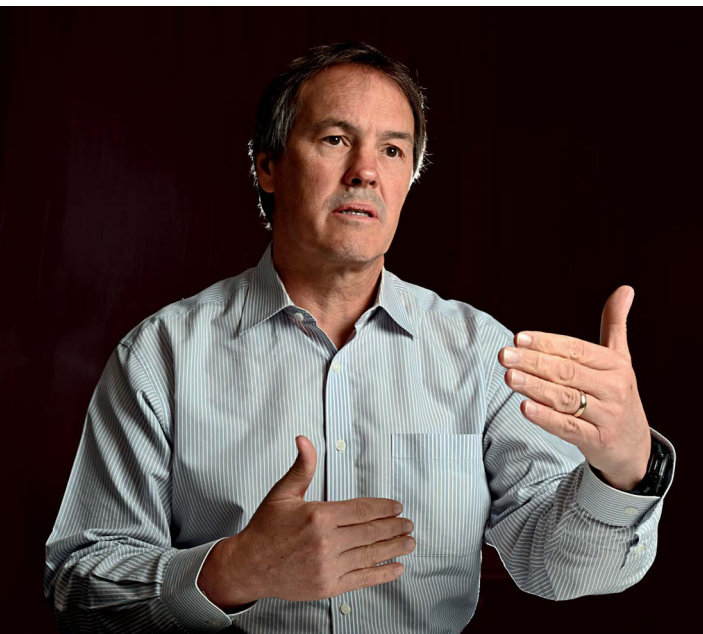




14 | size of the farms there and the ownership, which enable this growth. The other thing in Brazil is that they are very focused on specific field crops. For instance, corn and soybean, in particular, are exported to China. That makes it a relatively simple agronomic system.

“What stands out about India is the extent of small holdings, diversity of crops and markets, plus the monsoon-driven nature of agriculture. You have tropical, subtropical crops all in one country”

In India, the local diets and the diversity of crops lead to a more complex system at that same level.

So, it's not as essential as India but still critical enough that the government wants to facilitate the industry. Besides, it's also about geopolitics and trade. I think that's a good lesson for many countries, including India. If you really want to support an

industry and think about the export opportunities India has in the future, then it is important for the government to facilitate that from a technology and trade perspective. You must support farmers—whether it's education, stewardship, or in any other manner.

Q: Has the role of governments across countries, therefore, become more important?

A: If you look at Brazil or maybe Argentina or Mexico or Chile, once agriculture moves to a more export-driven orientation, the government needs to facilitate trade. They become an ambassador for the sector to support trade, keep things open, and make it easy.

The relationship between countries, from a trade perspective, develops from there. Depending on how the Indian government views the opportunity for agricultural exports and how critical it feels agriculture is for bringing in foreign exchange, it would absolutely [need to] support farmers.

Q: Given the challenging world dynamics today, how does that complicate things for your business?

A: There is no doubt that it is a very difficult and unpredictable scenario. At the same time, things are evolving to more identifiable spheres. For example, you have the smallholder markets, which have been obviously focused on domestic production and food